

Chapter 53-5

There were only a few minutes left before the concert began, and the concert hall was almost full.

Liang Shi had bought tickets early and got excellent seats. She led Xu Qingzhu to find their seats.

Liang Shi first settled Xu Qingzhu down, then went to the restroom. When she returned, the pianist was already seated at the piano, the lights in the concert hall dimmed, and Liang Shi, afraid of blocking the view of those behind her, bent over as she made her way to the inner seat.

Next to them was a couple who seemed to be having some issue—the woman was making a fuss about changing seats. Liang Shi listened in on their gossip.

Suddenly, some unknown force pushed her, and she lost her footing, falling straight backward.

Xu Qingzhu reached out to pull her up, and she ended up sitting directly on Xu Qingzhu's lap.

As luck would have it, she was too heavy.

The weight made Xu Qingzhu let out a muffled groan in the darkness.

Carrying some indescribable undertones.

Liang Shi swallowed hard, but her hands instinctively hooked around Xu Qingzhu's neck out of survival instinct, holding onto her.

The lights in the entire venue went out, and the piano music began at just the right moment.

Liang Shi's hand happened to intertwine with Xu Qingzhu's, transmitting moist heat through their palms.

Her heart was beating extremely fast—whether from fright or something else—but it was all drowned out by the piano music.

While she was lost in thought, Xu Qingzhu suddenly asked in a low voice, "Teacher Liang¹, are you sitting comfortably?"

Footnotes:

1. **Teacher Liang:** Xu Qingzhu uses a formal/teasing address here, as "老师" (teacher) can be used playfully between close acquaintances to create distance or tease someone, especially in situations with subtle romantic tension.